

# STEP BY STEP

## STEP 1

### Collection of list of colleges to be included in the study

A list of more than 1,500 colleges in the streams of arts, science, commerce, engineering, medicine and law was prepared using the existing list of colleges collated over a period of 14 years and through various secondary data sources like the Internet, published reports and the Association of Indian Universities Handbook.

## STEP 2

### Calculation of the parameter-wise ranks and the perceptual ranks at the city and zonal levels

- The experts were first asked to distribute 100 points across five vital parameters—Reputation of College, Quality of Academic Input, Student Care, Infrastructure and Job Prospects. The importance for each parameter was then derived.
- The experts were then asked to rate the performance (on a five-point scale) of colleges on these parameters based on their perception but were not allowed to rate their own colleges. In arts, science and commerce, 243 experts rated colleges only for their city. For engineering, medicine and law, 160 experts rated the colleges for their respective zone (north, south, east and west).
- Based on the ratings by experts, the perceptual scores of colleges was calculated. This score was derived by assigning weights to the levels of performance and multiplying them by the frequency of response. The performance score thus derived for each parameter was then multiplied with the importance of that parameter to get a perceptual score for it.
- All the parameter scores were then added to arrive at the overall perceptual score of a college, on the basis of which we arrived at the perceptual ranking of the colleges.

## STEP 3

### Calculation of the parameter-wise ranks and the perceptual ranks at the national level

- On the basis of Step 2, all colleges to be evaluated at the national level were tabulated. Another 247 experts rated the colleges, both at the national and city levels. For engineering, medicine and law streams, 157 experts rated the colleges.
- The same process was then used to arrive at the overall perceptual ranking of colleges at the national and the city levels. On the basis of the perceptual score of a parameter, the perceptual ranking for each parameter was arrived at.

## STEP 4

### Calculation of factual ranks

- The perceptual scores at the national level formed the basis for colleges to be rated for factual ranking. The Top 50 colleges each for arts, science, commerce and the Top 25 for engineering, medicine and law were chosen.
- On the basis of responses from the previous survey, weightage for each parameter for factual ranking was decided. The weighted response on each parameter was then added up to arrive at the overall factual score.
- These factual scores thus formed the basis of arriving at the factual ranking.

## STEP 5

### Calculation of the final rank

- Thus, the rescaled perceptual score and the factual score of a college were added in the ratio of 60:40 to arrive upon the final scores for each college considered for the survey.
- The maximum overall perceptual score was then rescaled to 100 and the perceptual scores of all colleges were apportioned to this maximum score. This score helped in tabulating the final national rankings of colleges.

other than law. However, standalone colleges given the status of a deemed university, were a part of the study. The collection of factual data comprised Step 4 of the survey.

The final rankings in each of the six streams were arrived at by combining perceptual scores (output of Step 3) and factual scores (output of Step 4). A weightage of 60:40, altered from the previous weightage of 70:30, was assigned to the perceptual and factual scores respectively to give the final overall score, indexed to 100 and tabulated to arrive at the final rankings.

Opinions of nearly 1,000 experts at the level of principals, heads of department and deans were considered for various stages of the study in the months of January, February, March and April. The methodology of ranking, based on the perceptual and factual scores, provides a comprehensive picture of each college and institution rated in the survey of India's Best Colleges.

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